

The Return of the Kings

When the Resurgence brought the sidhe back from the Dreaming, it brought them into a changed world. The commoners, their former vassals, were now the lords and masters of their fortresses and manors.

The sidhe's reaction was unfortunate, and predictable.

Using Treasures thought long lost, the sidhe forced their former vassals into formal challenges, with ownership of the freeholds at stake. Most of the commoners were unprepared for and outmatched by the nobles, and the freeholds legally and mystically changed hands.

This practice has slowed in the last two decades, officially because the sidhe have acclimated to the changes during their absence. Despite this, they have not given back many of the reclaimed freeholds; those that pass back into commoner hands tend to end up with ennobled kiths.

Of course, some commoners have a different take on why the sidhe haven't taken all the freeholds: Freeholders were caught with their pants down once, and had their rightful lands ripped from them. Some factions have spent the last 50 years making sure it never happens again.

Harvesting Glamour

A freeholder may harvest Glamour by sleeping and dreaming in the balefire's light. When he awakens, he gains Glamour equal to the freehold's rank, up to his Glamour rating. He may also grant another changeling the right to harvest Glamour as a favor.

In cases where an oathcircle owns a freehold, the Glamour is split between members who dream in the balefire's light. No matter the freehold's rating, every member of the motley receives at least 1 point of Glamour.

Reaving Glamour

It is possible to harvest the balefire of a freehold for Glamour, even if one is not the owner or an approved guest. The practice is known as *Reaving*. Most rulers of both the Seelie and Unseelie courts have outlawed the practice, and penalties for performing a Reaving are swift and harsh. Often, the most frequent Reavers are the owners of the freehold themselves, greedy for more than their daily allotment.

System: The Reaver stands near the balefire and draws on his Banality, pushing it into the balefire to forcibly pull Glamour out. The player rolls a number of dice equal to his character's Banality (difficulty 7). The number of successes determines the amount of Glamour gained from the Reaving, even if the successes exceed the freehold's rating.

For every two successes above the level of the freehold, the balefire becomes unstable and the freehold loses one rank. Lost levels regenerate at a rate of one per season (if the balefire is harvested daily) or one per month (if the balefire is given time to recuperate).

Glades

Typically little more than a wellspring that has pierced the barrier naturally, Glades are precious and rare in the modern world. They vary widely in appearance: They may be high mountain springs, a sun-drenched meadow, or a tiny clearing deep in a mist-shrouded wood.

Glades do not have balefires. Instead, their power is centered around a sacred stone. This stone may take the form of a river-smoothed rock, a sparkling raw gemstone tumbled from the mountain, or a standing stone ringed with flowers. If this stone is ever removed or destroyed, the Glade is stripped of its magic and fades into oblivion.

Unlike artificial freeholds, only a single person may harvest Glamour from the sacred stone. No matter how many slumber in the bounds of the Glade, only the first to sleep and dream collects the Glamour.

Most known Glades in the Americas are in the possession of the Nunnehi, despite many historical attempts by European fae to wrest control away.

- ☛ **Glens** — Glades located in meadows and fields.
- ☛ **Hollows** — Glades found in forested regions.
- ☛ **Eyries** — Glades in high, mountainous regions.
- ☛ **Subterranea** — Glades located in cave systems and caverns.
- ☛ **Grottos** — underwater or lagoon Glades, often controlled by merfolk or aquatic Nunnehi.
- ☛ **Isles** — Glades that encompass small islands. Often refined into manors or strongholds. One famous example is Avalon, the legendary island on which King Arthur Pendragon was interred, and from which he is foretold to rise again in Britain's greatest hour.
- ☛ **Rings** — the smallest kind of Glade, barely more than a path, and often a simple circle of mushrooms in a field.

Freeholds

In the Mythic Ages, freeholds were as wide and varied as mortal dreams. Castles spun in the clouds, forests of thorn and bone grew menacingly around a sky-piercing tower, and underwater grottos housed a wild assortment of fish and aquatic fae. Most legendary freeholds had numerous raths (doorways between the Dreaming and the Autumn World where one may step from one into the other), connected trods to dream realms, and satiated the most ravenous fae with nigh-endless supplies of Glamour.

The world has moved on from those times. Modern freeholds are more structured, following a series of archetypes that offer increased stability against the ravages of Banality.